Darsh Gangakhedkar

408-912-6510 | darshr2d2@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/darsh-gangakhedkar-ai | github.com/Darshmello | San Jose, CA

Education

University of California, Merced Merced, CA

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Engineering *May 2026*

- Relevant Coursework: Deep Learning, NLP, Computer Vision, AI/Model Evaluation, Distributed Systems, Software Engineering, Data Structures & Algorithms, Linear Algebra, Numerical Methods.

Experience

AI Engineer Intern Jan. 2026 – May 2026

SupHerb Farms & Telit Cinterion *Merced, CA*

- Accomplished a fully automated capture-to-query system, achieving ∼85% biomass estimation accuracy and a 0.78 Mean IoU (Intersection over Union) against ground-truth evaluations, by developing a 3D Gaussian Splatting pipeline integrating YOLOv9 and SAM.
- Enabled zero-downtime model updates for large-scale 3D reconstructions by deploying FastAPI services on Modal A100 GPUs, with optimized SQL data transformations supporting real-time querying.

AI Engineer Sep. 2025 – Present

Water Systems Management Lab, UC Merced *Merced, CA*

- Accomplished highly reliable data retrieval, improving Execution Accuracy (EX) from 61% to 84% and Exact Set Match (ESM) to 76% across 700,000+ records, by engineering an LLM-based NL-to-SQL application with rigorous automated evaluation pipelines.
- Boosted recall for drought-driven land changes by 28%, delivering highly reliable acreage forecasts, by engineering predictive pipelines and executing strict temporal evaluation procedures.

AI Researcher May 2025 – Aug. 2025

DOE TEAMUP Project – Perovskite Solar Cell Research *Merced, CA*

- Accomplished a 400% expansion of the training dataset, improving rare-defect weighted F1 score from 0.43 to 0.61, by building and systematically evaluating a GAN-based synthetic data pipeline in PyTorch.
- Standardized cross-institutional data analysis, achieving 100% reproducible environments for external partners, by containerizing SciPy and Pandas evaluation tooling on GCP via Docker.

Founder & President Sep. 2024 – Present

Machine Learning Club, UC Merced *Merced, CA*

- Accelerated autonomous e-bike development, securing grant funding and successful simulated validation, by leading a 15+ student team to deploy and evaluate a PyTorch/OpenCV object detection system.
- Educated 15+ students on production-grade AI systems by designing technical sessions on Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), guiding student project teams to improve RAGAS Context Precision from 0.65 to 0.88.

Projects

Robust LLM Evaluation: Multi-Run Consistency Framework | *Python, GPT-4, Claude 3, Llama 3* Mar. 2026

- Accomplished a robust automated grading system, achieving 89% agreement with human evaluators (Cohen's Kappa of 0.82), by developing a multi-run universal self-consistency framework using LLM-as-a-judge techniques.
- Mitigated positional bias via response-order randomization and reduced evaluation variance by 18% across 900+ test instances, using AST-based Python output parsing and LC-WinRate validation to eliminate format-related judge errors.

Apple Container MCP Eval Harness | *Go, Python, Model Context Protocol (MCP)* Sep. 2026

- Accomplished highly optimized JSON tool schemas for agentic workflows, improving LLM tool-calling accuracy from 74% to 89% and reducing parameter hallucination rates to <2%, by engineering a custom Python evaluation harness.
- Delivered a secure execution environment for local AI agents, achieving 100% safe-refusal across tested destructive-operation cases, by building a Go-based Model Context Protocol (MCP) server mapped to the Apple Container CLI.

ModelGate: Sandboxed Model Evaluation Engine | *Python, FastAPI, Daytona, Agentic Orchestration* Aug. 2026

- Prevented flawed model deployments, automatically blocking models failing out-of-sample risk metrics while maintaining a false-positive rejection rate under 3%, by engineering an autonomous FastAPI evaluation gate.
- Ensured full traceability for production updates by orchestrating an agentic development pipeline with a cryptographically hashed audit ledger, achieving a 100% pass rate across 42 TDD-driven tests.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, SQL, Java, JavaScript, Go, C++

AI / ML & Evals: LLM Evaluation (LLM-as-a-judge, RAGAS), Benchmarking, PyTorch, TensorFlow, HuggingFace, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), Prompt Engineering, OpenCV, LlamaIndex

Cloud & Tools: AWS, GCP, Modal, Docker, Apple Containers, FastAPI, Git, CI/CD, Linux